

FIELD MANUAL NO. 01 — SELF-POSITIONING

The Architecture of You

Discover the hidden operating system behind how you think, create, and make decisions — 20 questions, three tests, and one map that tells you what to actually sell.

20 QUESTIONS

3 TESTS

1 CANVAS

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This is not a personality quiz.

It's an audit. Most positioning advice starts with a job title and works backward. This manual starts with evidence — what people actually ask you for, what you actually deliver, what you're actually paid for — and works forward to a title, if you even need one.

This workbook won't tell you who to become. It will reveal who you've already been.

HOW IT WORKS

Three rounds of questions, answered fast and honestly — not impressively. Round 1 finds your patterns. Round 2 tests them against what actually drains or energizes you. Round 3 tests them against what the market will pay for. Then you build the Canvas: one page that names your three most sellable skills and scores each one.

GROUND RULES

Write what people actually ask you, not what you wish they'd ask. If your honest answer is "I don't know," write that — it's data. If an answer feels too easy or obvious to count, write it anyway. Obvious-to-you is usually invisible to everyone else, which is exactly why it's worth money.

What you'll walk away with: a completed Skills Canvas — your Innate Strengths, Marketable Skills, and Unique Positioning, each scored on whether it's Natural, Practical, and Measurable — plus a one-sentence answer to "so what do you actually do?"

WHO THIS IS FOR

Freelancers, founders, and career-changers whose work spans more than one discipline — and who've never found a single job title that covers it. If you've ever gone quiet when someone asked "so what do you do?", this manual is built for that exact moment.



01 ROUND ONE

The Pattern Finder

Find what you actually do, before you decide what to call it. Answer in a few sentences each — don't polish it.

Q.01

When someone says "I'm stuck," what kind of problem are they usually asking you to help with?

Not what you'd like them to ask. What do they actually ask?

Q.02

Think about the last ten people you've genuinely helped. What did they walk away with?

Examples: clarity, confidence, a website, a song, a strategy, connections, a system, an introduction, better writing.

Q.03

What kinds of work make you completely lose track of time?

Not because they're fun — because they pull you in.

ROUND ONE, CONTINUED

Q.04

What do you notice that most people seem blind to?

Could be in people, products, businesses, or culture.

Q.05

When have you been paid, or repeatedly thanked, for something that felt almost unfairly easy?

Those moments are the most valuable data in this whole manual.

Q.06

Someone hands you £50,000. You have 90 days. You can't spend it on ads. Turn it into £150,000. What would you build, and why that?

Pause here. Reread Q1–Q6. Underline any word or outcome that shows up more than once. That's the beginning of a pattern — carry it into Round Two.



02 ROUND TWO

The Friction Test

Patterns aren't all equal. Some things you're good at should stay hobbies. This round separates what's sustainable from what only looks good on paper — answer with brutal honesty.

Q.07

What work drains you, even if you're good at it?

Q.08

What work energizes you, even when nobody is watching?

Q.09

What kinds of people seem to "find" you naturally?

Artists, founders, developers, executives, community leaders, students?

Q.10

What compliments have you heard so many times that you've stopped believing they're special?

Q.11

If every qualification disappeared tomorrow — no CV, no degree, no title — how would you convince someone to hire you?

Notice the overlap. Whatever energizes you in Q8 and whatever people compliment in Q10 — if they point at the same thing, that's no longer a guess. That's a signal.

03 ROUND THREE

The Market Reality Test

This is where a skill and a marketable skill stop being the same sentence. Answer for what's true today, not what you hope becomes true.

Q.12

What measurable change can you repeatedly create for someone else?

Examples: launch faster, increase revenue, write clearer copy, grow a community, automate a task, connect the right people.

Q.13

If you interviewed ten people you've worked with, what would all ten agree you're unusually good at?

Q.14

If you disappeared from a project tomorrow, what would be hardest to replace?

ROUND THREE, CONTINUED

Q.15

What's the hardest thing you've learned that now feels effortless?

Q.16 – Finish the sentence without overthinking

People don't realize I can actually _____.

You now have sixteen honest answers. That's more evidence than most people ever collect about themselves. The next two pages turn that evidence into a shortlist — then a scored, sellable Canvas.

WORD / OUTCOME THAT REPEATS	WHICH QUESTIONS?	WHAT IT SUGGESTS

The scoring filter

Score each of your three candidates 1–5 on each test. A skill only earns a place on your Canvas if it scores reasonably across all three — a skill that's Natural but not Practical is a hobby; Practical but not Natural is a burnout risk.

CANDIDATE SKILL	NATURAL Easier for you than most people?	PRACTICAL Is anyone paying for it today?	MEASURABLE Provable by outcome, not credential?
1.	/ 5	/ 5	/ 5
2.	/ 5	/ 5	/ 5
3.	/ 5	/ 5	/ 5

A note on honesty: a low Practical score isn't a failure — it just means that skill isn't your business yet, even if it stays part of your identity. This filter exists to stop you from building a career on the wrong layer.

ONE LAYER BENEATH THE THREE

If your three candidates look unrelated on the surface — a craft, a way of working with people, a type of judgment — look for the process underneath them. What do you always do first, second, third, regardless of the domain? That underlying sequence is your Unique Positioning: the thing a competitor can copy a skill but not copy a sequence.

The Skills Canvas

This is the one page that leaves the workbook. Fill it from your scoring table. Keep every description to one line — if it needs a paragraph, it isn't clear yet.

01

Innate Strength

What you naturally do better than most people, unprompted, before anyone pays you for it.

NATURAL

/5

PRACTICAL

/5

MEASURABLE

/5

02

Marketable Skill

What organisations, founders, or clients are actively willing to pay for today — not eventually.

NATURAL

/5

PRACTICAL

/5

MEASURABLE

/5

03

Unique Positioning

The combination that's hard to replace — where your strength and your market skill meet.

NATURAL

/5

PRACTICAL

/5

MEASURABLE

/5

I help _____ do _____
so that _____.

You've Found Your Architecture

Not another exercise — a synthesis. The Canvas names what you sell. This page names what you run on. Write each as a statement, not a question — you already have the evidence, so finish these as commitments, not open questions.

01

The problems I naturally solve are...

02

The environments that energize me are...

03

The pattern I repeatedly notice is...

04

The transformation people experience after working with me is...

05

I'm going to stop trying to be...

06

From today forward, I want to become known for...

The positioning sentence

A Canvas is for you. A sentence is for everyone else. Build it in layers — each one gets used in a different place.

THE ONE-LINE ANSWER — for "so what do you do?"

One sentence, no jargon, no job title. Say the outcome, not the method.

THE BIO LINE — for a website, LinkedIn, or proposal

Two to three sentences: who you help, what changes for them, and the evidence it's true.

THE PROOF LINE — one number or named outcome

A result you can point to. If you don't have one yet, that's the next thing to go get — see the plan on the next page.

Test it out loud. Say the one-line answer to someone who's never worked with you. If they ask a follow-up question instead of nodding politely, it's working.

The 7-day proof plan

A Canvas is a hypothesis until someone else confirms it. This is the fastest, cheapest way to test it — no website, no branding, no software.

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- 01 **List five people** who match who you wrote in your positioning sentence — people who've had the problem you solve, or know someone who does.
 - 02 **Send one message each**, offering a short, paid session built around your Unique Positioning — not a favour, a paid pilot. Keep the price low enough to be an easy yes.
 - 03 **Deliver it live**, no automation. Take notes on the exact questions you ask and where the other person's energy shifts — that's your method revealing itself.
 - 04 **Ask for one sentence** afterwards: "what changed for you?" Save their words — this becomes your proof line.
 - 05 **Repeat with the next two people** before changing anything. Three data points beat one strong opinion.

What you're testing: not whether you can talk about your skills convincingly — whether a stranger will pay, show up, and leave changed. That's the only test that counts before you build anything bigger.



BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS

One honest note

This manual finds the pattern. It doesn't finish the work. A completed Canvas is evidence, not proof — the only thing that turns it into proof is doing the 7-day plan with real people, more than once. If nothing changes after that, the candidate skill wasn't it, and that's useful too: cross it off and score a different one.

Keep this manual. Most people's positioning shifts as they grow — the questions stay useful long after the first answers stop being true. Rerun it in a year.

NOTES

COLOPHON

The Architecture of You

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